MEMORANDUM

Delivery Performance & Customer Satisfaction — Key Findings and Recommendations

To: Executive Leadership Team

From: Michael Hoover, Data Analytics

Date: Sept 2026

Re: Marketplace delivery delays and their impact on customer satisfaction

Executive Summary

Targeted fixes to one underperforming region and a small group of sellers offer the fastest, lowest-cost path to improving customer satisfaction. A review of nearly **99,000 marketplace orders** identifies late deliveries as the single strongest driver of poor customer reviews. Roughly **7,800 orders** arrived after their promised delivery date. The problem is concentrated, not marketplace-wide: **one region** — responsible for just 12.8% of order volume — accounts for 21.3% of all late deliveries, driven by carrier-transit inconsistency nearly double the marketplace's most reliable region. Separately, sellers with on-time delivery rates below **80%** average review scores **20% lower (3.35 vs. 4.19)** than compliant sellers. Closing these two gaps will move the needle on customer experience far more efficiently than any broad, marketplace-wide initiative.

Key Findings

- **Late deliveries drive dissatisfaction.** Orders delivered late receive substantially lower customer review scores than on-time orders — scores fall 16% in the first 1–3 days late, then drop a further 40% from that already-lower level in days 4–6 (a cumulative decline of roughly 49% from the on-time baseline), before largely leveling off by day 7.
- **One region is disproportionately unreliable, not simply high-volume.** Rio de Janeiro (RJ) generates 21.3% of all late deliveries on just 12.8% of order volume — the marketplace's clearest case of underperformance relative to size. The root cause isn't shipping speed: RJ's carrier-transit-time variability (10.7-day std. dev.) is nearly double São Paulo's (5.7), despite São Paulo handling roughly three times RJ's order volume while maintaining the marketplace's most consistent carrier performance.
- **A small seller segment carries outsized reputational risk.** 10.6% of sellers fall below an 80% on-time delivery standard, and this group averages 3.35 out of 5 in customer reviews versus 4.19 for compliant sellers — a 0.84-point (20%) gap tied directly to delivery reliability.

Recommendations

1. Prioritize a carrier-reliability audit in RJ. RJ's problem is inconsistency, not scale — improving carrier-transit predictability there addresses the region's disproportionate share of late deliveries directly.
2. Establish a minimum delivery-performance standard for sellers. Sellers below an 80% on-time threshold should receive a formal improvement plan, with account-level consequences for sustained non-compliance.
3. Set proactive customer communication for at-risk orders. Automated delay notifications for orders trending late can reduce the satisfaction penalty even when the delivery itself cannot be sped up.

Expected Impact

Closing even half the gap between compliant and non-compliant sellers could lift several thousand orders per year into the higher-satisfaction tier. Stabilizing RJ's carrier-transit variability toward São Paulo's benchmark carries the potential to meaningfully reduce late deliveries in the region, given how disproportionately RJ's inconsistency drives the current gap. These are directional estimates intended to guide prioritization, not committed targets.